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AI, VET and the EU skilling challenge: Cedefop's evidence

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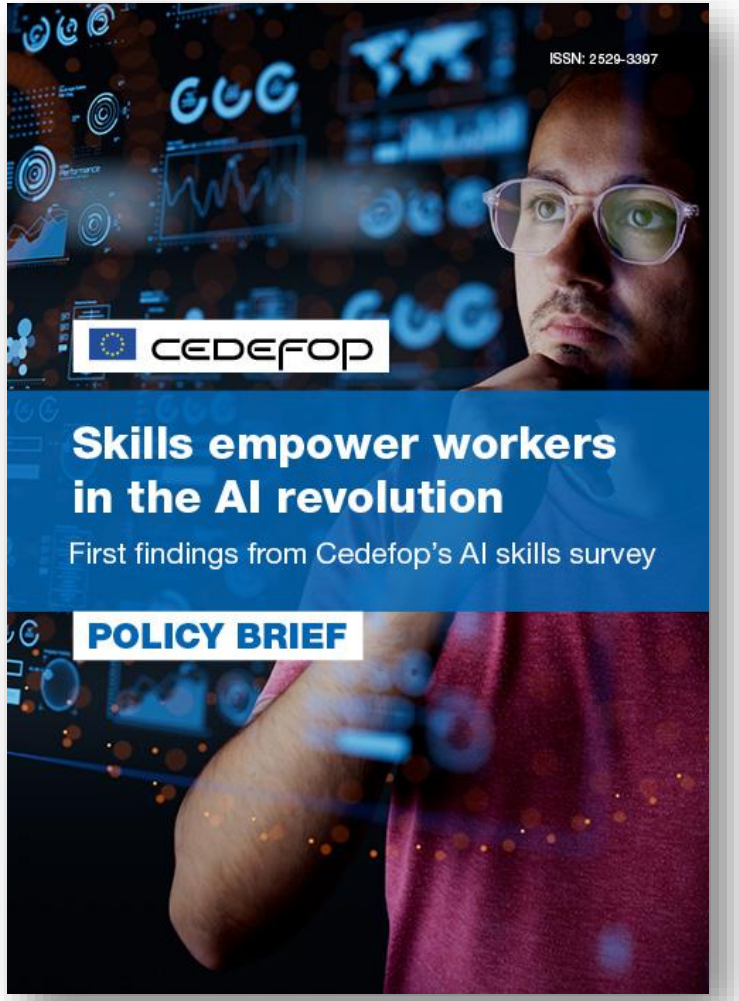
Cedefop AI skills survey

Representative survey of 5342 adult workers in 11 EU countries in 2024



Measurement of

- AI use at work
- AI competency/skill gaps
- Automatability of jobs
- Organisational support
- AI outcomes



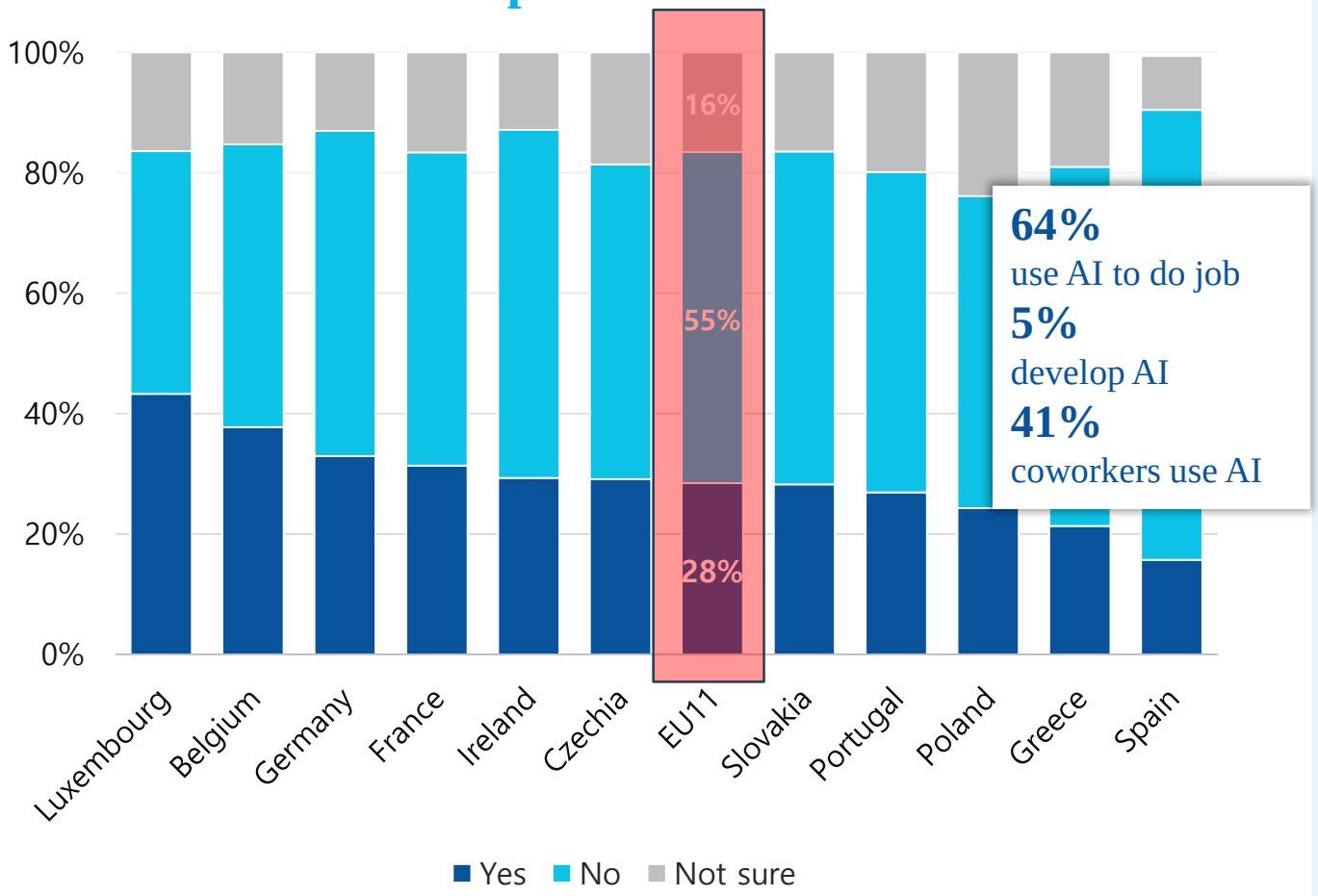
https://www.cedefop.europa.eu/et/publications/9201

AI in EU workplaces

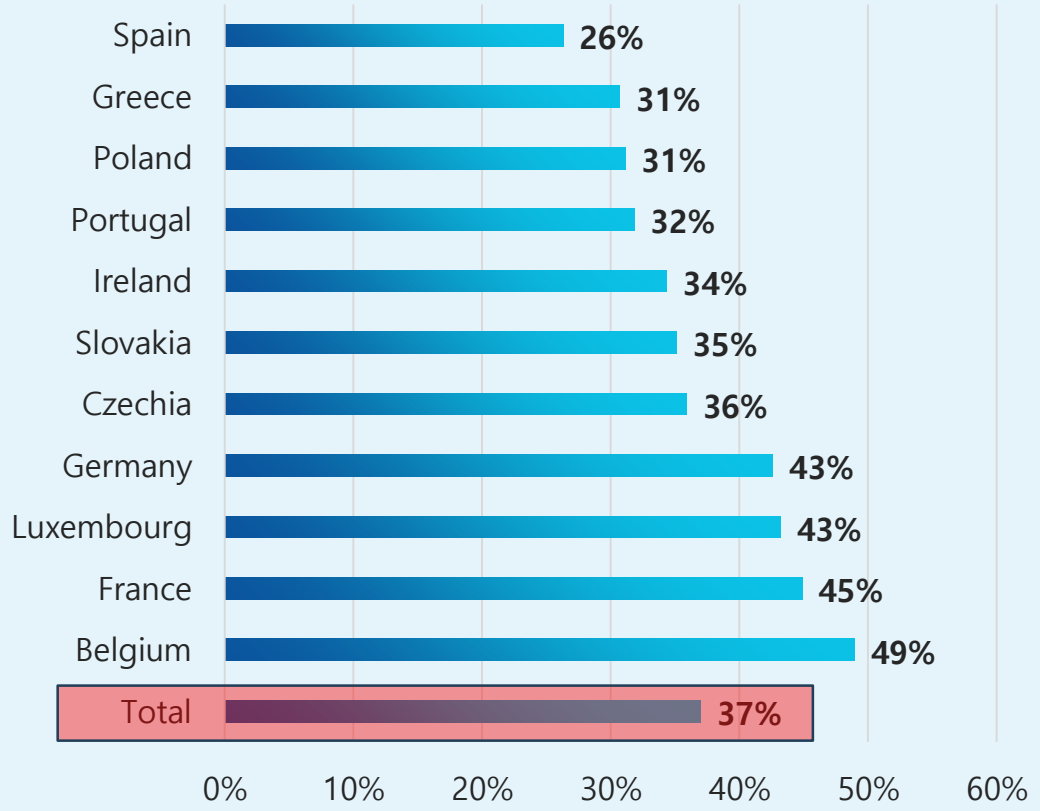
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Another great divergence?

Use of AI at workplace



Increasing use of AI



Source: Cedefop AI skills survey (2024)

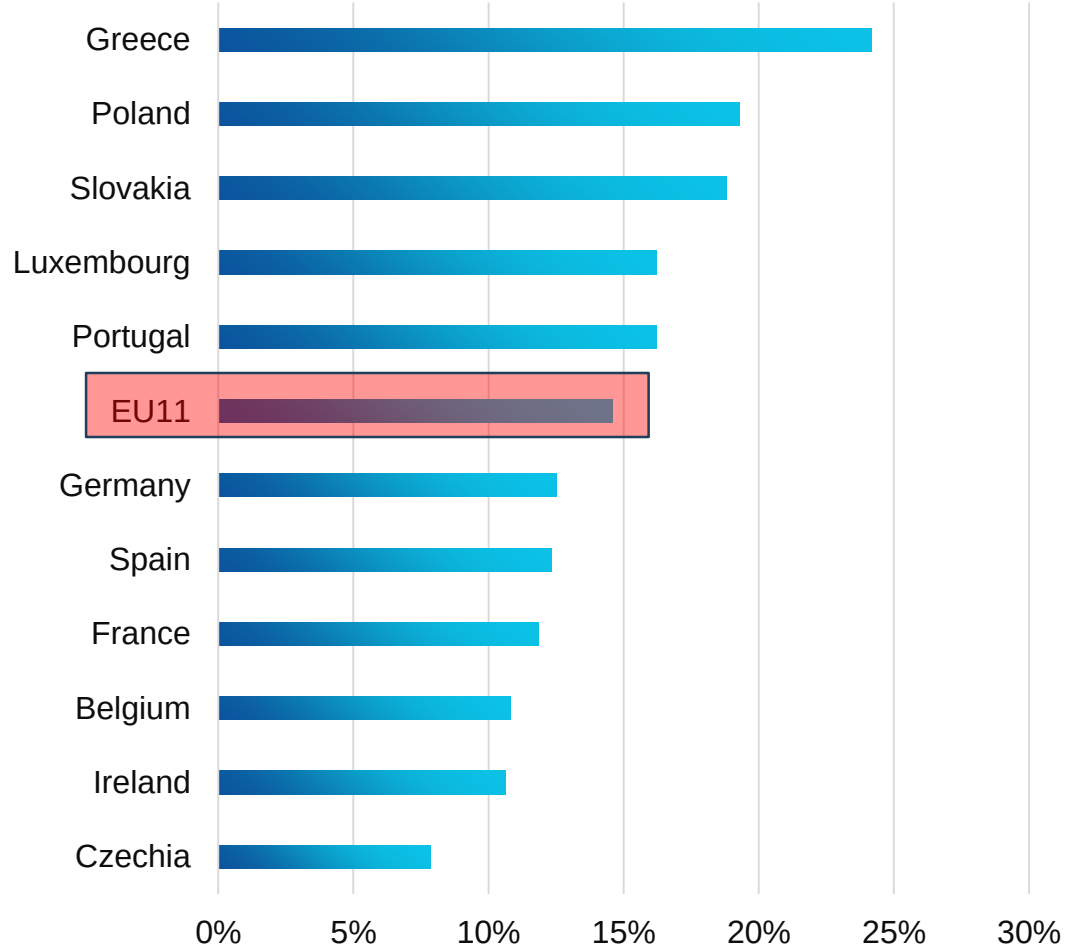
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Automation or job redesign?

Job automation
highest in routine, precarious, middle-skilled jobs using machines



Fear of job loss due to AI (% all)



Source: Cedefop AI skills survey (2024)

Automation or job redesign?

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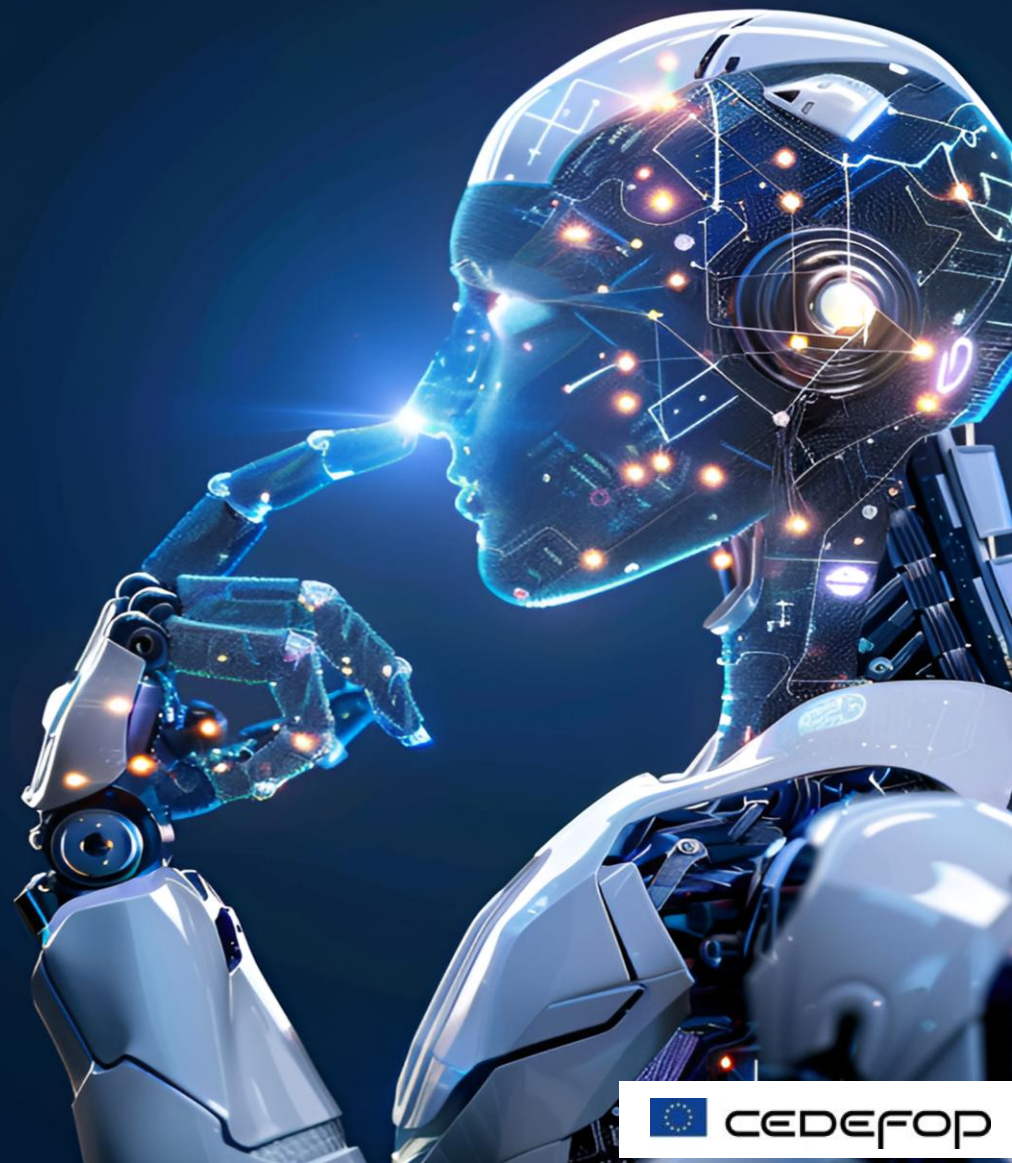
AI and task automation

30 %
do not do some tasks anymore

41 %
now do some new or different tasks

67 %
do some tasks faster than before

17 %
have less control over job tasks



Source: Cedefop AI skills survey (2024)

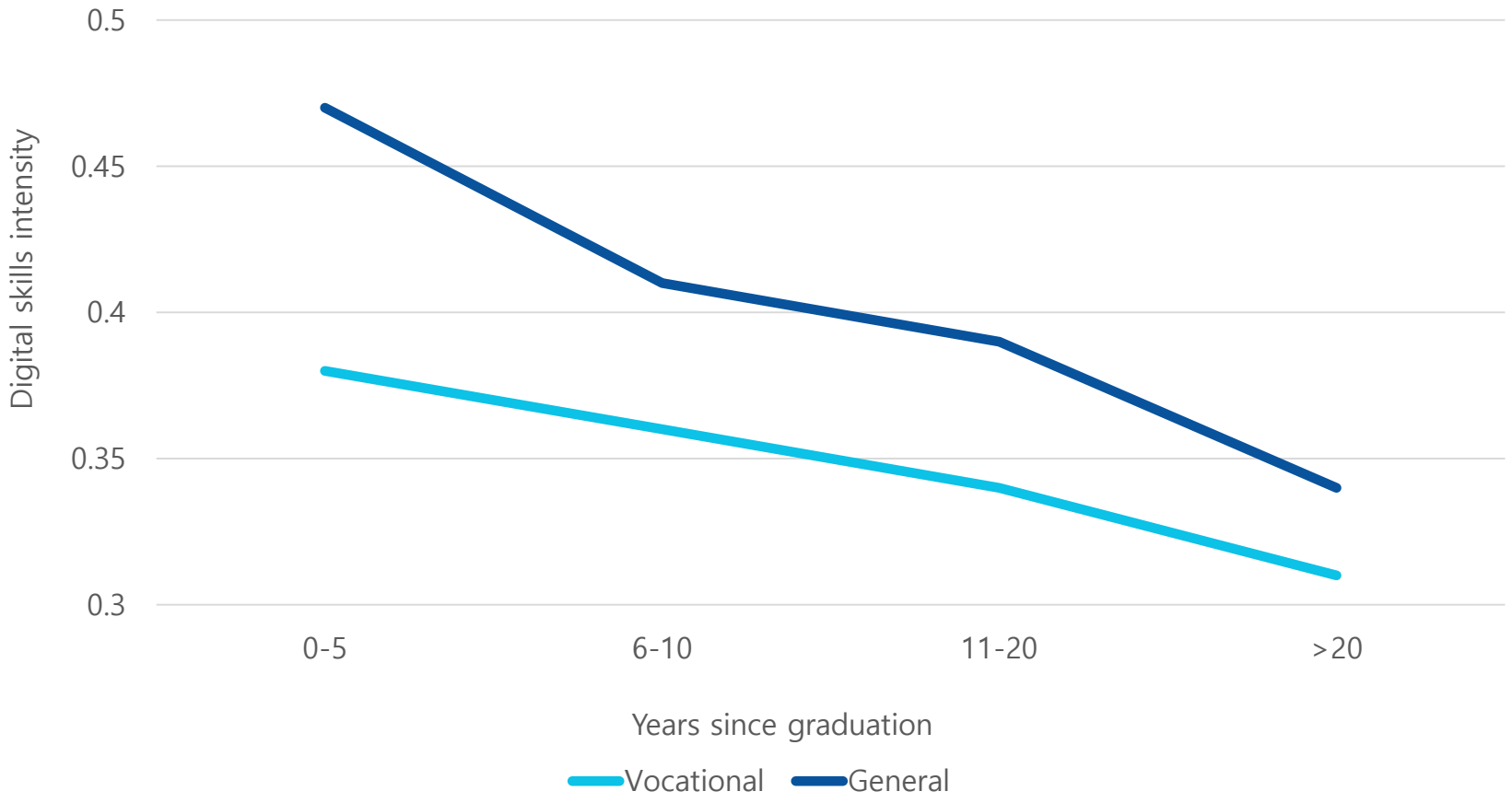
Source: Cedefop AI skills survey (2024)

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VET graduates: (better matched but) in less digital jobs

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Digital skills intensity of jobs by programme orientation & years of graduation



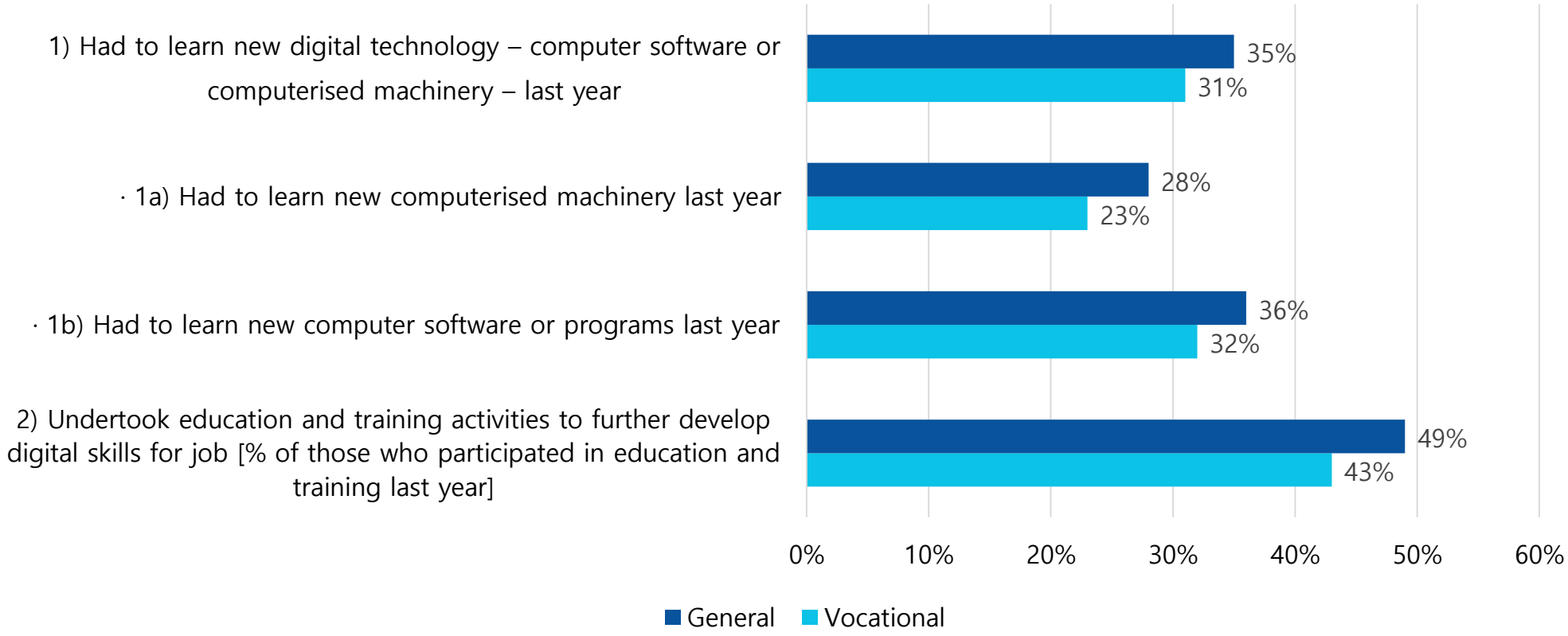
Source: Cedefop ESJS2, VET needs to go digital (2025)

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Low skill needs compromise digital upskilling

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Digital upskilling by programme orientation



Source: Cedefop ESJS2, VET needs to go digital (2025)

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AI and VET: threat or chance?

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- From muscle to mind
- Reshoring production
- Possible inter- / intrasectoral/organisational productivity spillovers
- Possible enhanced value of craftmanship
- Need for STEAM



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AI upskilling: bridging the AI skill gap

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61%

will need new knowledge and skills to deal with AI impact on their work



44%

unlikely their company or organisation will provide training to workers to deal with AI

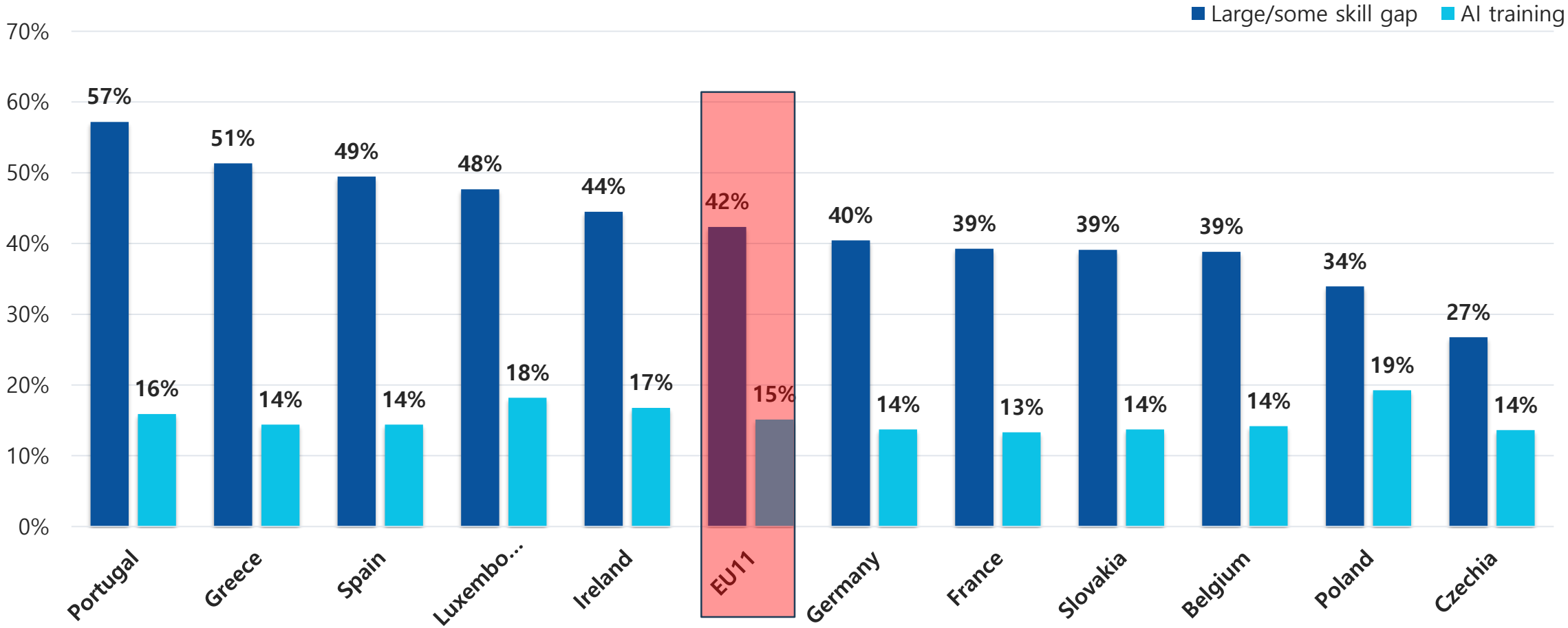


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AI upskilling: bridging the AI skill gap

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AI upskilling needs and training



Source: Cedefop AI skills survey (2024)

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Powering the AI transition

Informing VET policies

AI transition = skills transition

Target AI use and upskilling to older, female workers in SMEs

Improving AI competences

- Major driver of AI take-up/training
- AI use is skills-based



Next steps: AI in EU workplaces

Purpose of the study

- Conduct three medium-term foresight exercises (automotive, geriatric nursing, creative industries)
- Collect relevant qualitative data

Main aims

- Explore factors affecting AI adoption & diffusion
- Identify effect for future skill gaps & workers' needs

Time frame

- 2024-2026



First results for the automotive sector

AI adoption and regulation

- AI complements human labour, needing human oversight
- Slow AI adoption hinders innovation compared to the USA / China
- Balance between regulation and innovation

Education and Industry Challenges

- Education systems fall short for skilled workers; public-private approach needed
- Cost factors and geopolitical shifts impact industry more than AI adoption



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Thank you

For more information
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